

STATUS OF IMMIGRATION

(A CASE STUDY OF SHANKHARAPUR MUNICIPALITY WARD 9, SANKHU)

A

Thesis Proposal

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Acronym

No.	Number
NPC	National Planning Commission
CEDA	Centre for Economic Development and Administration
UN	United Nations
UNFPA	United Nations Population Fund

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Chapter One

Introduction

1.1 Background of the Study

Migration is one of the major components of population change which is basically caused by socio-economic factors. It is one of the demographic phenomena which causes significant change in various aspects of life basically the socio-economic changes. It affects not only the size of the population but also changes its structure and social characteristics. Migration is not only the factor of population change; there are other biological factors, namely fertility and mortality, which have adverse effects on population change.

Migration affects not only the population size of origin but also the destination point of migrant people. Socio-economic factors are the main causes why people migrate from one place to another. In addition, it is very difficult to know why some people migrate from one place to another particular place.

The United Nations Multilingual Dictionary also defined migration as "a form of geographic mobility or spatial mobility between one geographical unit and another, generally involving change in residence from the place of origin or place of departure to the place of destination or place of arrival." (United Nations [UN], 1973, p. 173).

Migration is a special mobility of people by changing usual place of residence to a well-defined destination. A migrant is a person who moves either from his place of birth to another area or keeps on moving stepwise or circularly by changing his residence more or less frequently by being seasonal, temporary, semi-permanent, depending upon the duration of migration and reason for migration within a defined geographical area (KC B. K., Internal migration in Nepal, 2003).

Migration is a barometer of changing social, economic and political circumstances at the national and international level. In all cases, migration is a sign of wide disparities in economic and social conditions between origin and destination, both caused by better and cheaper transports and communication facilities. Another common feature is unpredictable

and volatile movement as the result of specific short term or long-term crises. Most of these crises produce in the first place local rather than international movements through migrants may cross borders in search of their security (United Nations Population Fund [UNFPA], 1993).

According to classical economic theorem migration balances the distribution of population and the supply of resources. People move from poor area to rich resource. Migration is broadly divided into two divisions, one is internal and another is international migration. Internal migration is the migration within country i.e. in migration and out migration while international migration refers to the movement of people from one country to another i.e. immigration and emigration.

As a mechanism of balancing population and actual resources it is one of central interest to the study of population environmental relationship and economic development. Migration may occur from one village to another, within the districts or between the districts and within the country or outside the country people move largely because of economic motives. Similarly, selectively among migrants may also occur by age and sex. In India and Nepal, large number of adults leaving their families behind in the native village, such movements are largely due to economic motives where employment opportunities attract rural males to urban centers but the high cost of urban living compels male migrants leave their families behind.

Process of migration is as old as human society. In early days there was primitive migration in which the natural forces were vital but as the time passed on gradually different types of migration appears in a early period. Natural force, primitive people shift them from one place to another but present there are not only forced immigration but also voluntary migration can be seen. In forced migration natural force, political force, political factors play an important role to shift the residence. Nepal has a long history of migration after the implantation of malaria eradication program; the process of migration started from hill and mountain to Terai and inner Terai and low land of the country.

Our country is divided into three ecological zones namely Mountain, Hill and Terai. These three ecological zones are divided into five development regions namely Eastern, Central,

Western, Mid-western and Far-western development regions. Again, these three ecological regions are divided into 14 zones and 75 districts.

The trend of migration appears both in internal and international level where, India is the major destination place of international emigrants. The flow of internal migration also is increasing rapidly during the last two decades from the Hilly and Mountain regions to Terai due to infrastructural development and availability of the social services in Terai. This trend of migration has two major effects. The first effect is lack of skillful and independent human resources in the place of origin and the second is high pressure in the social services and security in the place of destination. Internal migration is responsible to uneven distribution of population in Nepal.

The 2001 census of Nepal had included enough information to calculate four streams of migration within the country. In Nepal, the major streams of internal migration are rural-to-rural 68 percent, rural-to-urban 26 percent, urban-to-urban 3 percent and urban-to-rural 4 percent in 2001.

In the context of Nepal CEDA (Centre for Economic Development and Administration, 1977) carried out a study of immigration pattern in Kathmandu. The study focused that more than 50 percent of the migrants were of age group 20-30 years. The study also concluded that economic opportunities were the major causes of migration. The study further identified some causes of migration of people from hill areas of Central Nepal. It suggested that selective nature of age, sex, occupation, population pressure, food shortage and poverty in the hill region are the main reason for migration. The plan can control the volume of migration from hilly region the availability of intervening opportunities through investment in road and irrigation.

Unfortunately, the earthquake on April 25th 2015 and may 12th 2015 in Nepal have the massive destruction of many settlements of human population and lost many lives. The government of Nepal statistics states that 602,257 houses were fully destroyed and 285,099 houses were partially damaged with more than 8-billion-dollar losses (NPC, 2015). For facilitation the victim of earthquake Nepal government has projected many categories of sustenance tangible earthquake victim of Nepal.

1.2 Statement of the Problem

The process of migration has been gradually intensifying the existing settlement problem as well as creating new problem both at the place of origin and the place of destination. Migration is an important component in the socio economic and demographic land space of Nepal. Terai still continues to be the main recipient of both the internal and international migrants. Immigration is nowadays one of the major issues for most developing countries. Nepal is no exception and also suffering from the critical issues in migration. Nepal has culturally and ethnically complex society where is the result of migration activities, which range in physical type and cultural from Indians in south and Tibetan in the north.

The cause of migration can easily be identified but it is very difficult to find out the quality of the consequences of migration. Migration has short, medium and long-term effects show their evidence from so many years' migration and accept them as part of culture and society. In such a case only a very sensible and eventful research can identify such consequences.

This study area is ward no. 9 of Shankharapur Municipality which lies in the northern part of the country and of the developing municipality of capital city Kathmandu. This municipality is facing the continuous flow of immigration day by day which in turn have to faces many consequences that is positive or negative both side by side.

What are the trends of this movement?

What are the causes of this movement?

What are the consequences of this movement?

So, the main issue of this study is to examine the main trends, causes and consequences of immigration in the study area.

1.3 Objectives of the Study

The general objective of the study is to assess the status, trends and causes and consequences of immigration in Shankharapur municipality of ward no. 9.

1. To identify the main causes of immigration of people.

2. To analyze demographic migration trends.
3. To examine causes and consequences of immigration

1.4 Significance of the Study

This research is highly significant as it provides a comprehensive investigation into the causes, consequences, and socio-economic and demographic characteristics of migrants in Shankharapur Municipality Ward 9. Understanding these specific factors is critical for explaining the broader patterns and impacts of immigration within the context of rapid urban transformation.

Theoretical Significance

On a theoretical level, this research adds to the academic body of knowledge by scrutinizing the demographic trends and underlying drivers that fuel human movement in contemporary Nepal. While the sources suggest that identifying the causes of migration is often straightforward, this study seeks to perform the more complex task of evaluating the quality of the consequences through detailed, "sensible and eventful research". By exploring these patterns within the specific framework of rapid urban transformation, the study establishes a foundational reference for academics and provides a scholarly basis for future investigations into the relationship between migration and rural development.

Applied Significance

At the applied level, the findings offer functional insights for planners, policymakers, and development practitioners to better navigate the complexities of population shifts. By pinpointing the specific causes and consequences of immigration in Ward 9, the research facilitates the design of targeted interventions aimed at enhancing the living conditions of the local population. Furthermore, the study identifies localized dynamics that can be used to strengthen public participation and promote sustainable urban growth within the municipality. Ultimately, these practical outcomes are intended to help local authorities manage the continuous daily influx of migrants and the resulting pressure on social services and community security.

1.5 Limitations of the study

This study has several limitations that should be considered while interpreting the results. The research was conducted within a limited time frame, which constrained detailed primary data collection through interviews and limited the extent of secondary data collection from local-level institutions, particularly the ward office. The sample size was also limited, and therefore may not fully represent the entire migrant population of the study area. Moreover, the study is geographically confined to Shankharapur Municipality, Ward No. 9 (Sankhu), which restricts the generalization of findings to other areas. The study largely depends on information provided by respondents, which may be influenced by personal perceptions or reluctance to disclose sensitive economic and social information. In addition, financial and resource constraints restricted extensive fieldwork, and certain groups of migrants, such as temporary or seasonal migrants, may not have been adequately covered.

Despite these limitations, the study provides valuable insights into the status, causes, and consequences of immigration in the study area. The findings are considered sufficient to meet the objectives of the study and to support future research and planning initiatives.

1.6 Organization of the Study

The proposed study will be organized into five chapters. Chapter One will provide an introduction to the study, including the background, problem statement, objectives, rationale, significance, and limitations. Chapter Two will review the relevant literature on migration, with emphasis on its causes, consequences, and the demographic characteristics of migrants. Chapter Three will describe the research methodology, covering the study area, data sources, sampling techniques, and methods of data collection. Chapter Four will focus on the analysis and interpretation of the collected data. Finally, Chapter Five will present the summary of findings, conclusions, and practical recommendations based on the study.

Chapter-Two

Literature Review

Review of literature is an essential part of the research studies. It is a way to discover what other research of our problem has uncovered. A critical review of the literature helps the researcher to develop understanding and insight into problems research works that relates to the present study. It is also a way to avoid investigating problems that has already definitely answered.

In the context of Nepal Centre for Economic Development and Administration, (CEDA, 1973) carried out a study of immigration pattern in Kathmandu. The study focused that more than 50 percent of the migrants were of age group 20-30 years. The study also concluded that economic opportunities were the major causes of migration. The study further identified some causes of migration of people from hill areas of Central Nepal. It suggested that selective nature of age, sex, occupation, population pressure, food shortage and poverty in the hill region are the main reason for migration. The plan can control the volume of migration from hilly region the availability of intervening opportunities through investment in road and irrigation.

Ravenstein (1885) is the father of migration studies. He had brought the concept of migration and its stream. He explained that push and pull factors are the foundation of theory of migration. This article which is linked with demographic and economic variable in relation to distance and volume of migration also depends on distance. Ravenstein “Law of migration” states that migration occurs with stream and counter stream in each region as nations and universal. It has been widely accepted. Lee (1966) explained that the decision to migrate is governed by “push and pull factors”. She related pull factors to the destination which are attractive and always positive. On the other hand, push factors are explained as related to which are repulsive and always negative. Before migrating, individuals consider several aspects, including factors associated with the origin, factors related to the destination, intervening obstacles such as distance, transportation, and cost, as well as personal factors like age, sex, and education.

Stewart (1950) have attempted to explain the movement of individual. His theory is known as “Gravitational Theory” which states that the numbers of persons who move between two areas are directly proportional to the two populations and inversely proportional to the distance between them. Zipf was agreed with Ravenstein's view regarding to irritation. Gravity Model $m = a * u/v$, where, a is the number of migrants in a given stream. u and v independent variables (factors of attraction and distance) and a is the constant of proportionality. Zipf (1946) formulated “The principle of least effort”. His model was based on Ravenstein's theory of migration. He was agreed with Ravenstein's view regarding migration is inversely related to the distance to be travelled. According to him, the greater distance is effort required to overcome the difficulty and therefore the similar is the number of migrants. Similarly, the lesser the distance, the lesser is the efforts to overcome, as a result the greater is the number of migrants. Todaro (1976) has given the most significant contribution the large volume of migration literature. His view on migration mechanism can be explained by the differences in expected rather than actual earnings between two places. He has formulated migration models in four different features as: a. Migration is estimated primarily by national income considerations of relative benefits which are mostly traditional and psychological. b. The decision to migrate depends on expected rather than actual wage differentials. c. The probability of obtaining employment in the new sectors is inversely related to the unemployment rate in the new sector. d. Migration rates of new employment opportunity growth rates are not only possible but rational as well as and even likely in the face of wide new or old expected income differentials.

Gurung (1984) analyzes in his book ‘Inter Regional Migration in Nepal’, showed that population pressure, land holding, shortage of food grain, environmental stress in mountain/hill were found as the push factors and fertile land, resource government incentives, planned resettlement, physical facilities, presence of friends and relatives in the Terai were found as the pull factors. Facilities, presence of friends and relatives in the Terai were found as the pull factors.

K.C. (1998) studied the micro and macro level of rural analysis. Formal migration in Nepal based on data of Population Census 1961 and 1971 concluded that differentials in income

derived from the agriculture government resettlement project in Terai, government increased investment in irrigation, industrial activities, and administrative activities in specific towns were structural determinants of migration. For the micro level analysis, K.C. has shown that literary rate, age distribution, local social factors like family kinship were found major factors for the migration.

Kunwar (1993) analyzed the causes and consequences of internal migration phenomenon through the multivariate analysis as well as path model. He concluded that the low productivity and insufficient land are main causes of leaving origin and availability of physical facilities and extension of business opportunities reduce the causes of leaving origin but moving of relatives and friends and education increase the causes of leaving origin. He also concludes that the age factor also plays significant role in the process of migration.

During the time of Maoist insurgency people migrated from hill to Terai (Niroula, 2016). Other factors, which accelerated this process, were probably the population pressure creation of infrastructure and concentration of development activities that created opportunities for employment in the Terai. As a result, there are considerable changes in demographic, socio-economic and environmental condition both at the origin and destination.

Mabogunje (1970) applied a concept of system theory in the system of rural to urban migration operates having economic, social, technological and government component. He attempted to relate trends, patterns and implications of rural to urban migration with general system theory (KC,1993:3) the ground migration to be systematic, influenced by an environment and control mechanism may change the whole system.

Another study done by Gurung (1974) was on planned resettlement in western Terai. It was based on survey of Banke and Bardiya resettlement project. It included a view of resettlement scheme, characteristics of settlers in project area. Ethnic classification, income size of land holding and livestock of migrants.

Subedi (1996) studied on population growth and migration in Kathmandu city in which he concluded the internal and international migration are the main factors to increase population in Kathmandu city.

KC (1993) studied urbanization and migration in Nepal in which that concluded that international migration involving unrestricted emigration and immigration can be detrimental to the national interest but that should be beneficial if it is regulated properly.

2.1 Theoretical Review

Migration is a complex phenomenon influenced by economic, social, and environmental factors. Several theories have been developed to explain the process of migration. Ravenstein (1885), known as the father of migration studies, introduced the concept of migration streams and counter-streams, emphasizing that migration flows occur systematically between regions. He also highlighted the importance of distance in migration patterns. Lee (1966) extended this idea through the push-pull framework, explaining that migration decisions are influenced by factors at the origin (push) and destination (pull), as well as intervening obstacles such as distance, transportation, and cost. Personal characteristics like age, sex, and education further shape migration decisions. Zipf (1964) proposed the Gravitational Theory, suggesting that the number of migrants between two areas is directly proportional to their populations and inversely proportional to the distance separating them. Todaro (1976) added an economic perspective, emphasizing that expected income differentials, rather than actual earnings, largely drive migration. Together, these theories provide the conceptual foundation for understanding the causes and patterns of migration in Ward 9, Sankhu.

2.2 Empirical Review

Empirical studies in Nepal and similar contexts provide insights into migration trends and consequences. CEDA (1977) observed that over 50 percent of migrants in Kathmandu were aged 20–30 years, with economic opportunities being the primary cause. Gurung (1984) identified population pressure, land scarcity, and environmental stress in the hills as push factors, and fertile land, government incentives, and social networks in the Terai as pull

factors. K.C. (1998) analyzed both micro and macro-level determinants of migration, including literacy, age distribution, family kinship, and government resettlement projects. Kunwar (2015) applied multivariate analysis and found that low productivity and insufficient land prompted migration, while availability of facilities and presence of relatives influenced the decision to move. Niroula (2016) noted that during the Maoist insurgency, migration from hills to Terai accelerated due to population pressure, infrastructure development, and employment opportunities. These studies demonstrate the relevance of economic, social, and environmental factors in driving migration and highlight the need for a localized study in Ward 9, Sankhu.

2.3 Policy Review

Migration in Nepal has been shaped by both national and local policies. National policies, such as the Nepal Migration Policy and urban development strategies, aim to regulate population movement, improve resettlement programs, and create opportunities in underdeveloped regions. Local-level initiatives, including ward and municipal development plans, focus on infrastructure development, provision of basic services, and resettlement schemes to manage migration effectively. For example, previous resettlement projects in western Terai (Gurung, 1974) aimed to relocate populations from densely populated hill areas, emphasizing land distribution, income support, and social integration. Understanding these policies is essential to assess whether migration in Ward 9 aligns with policy objectives and to identify gaps where local planning can be improved.

2.4 Research Gap

Despite extensive studies on migration in Nepal, several gaps remain. Most studies are macro-level or city-wide, lacking focus on specific wards like Ward 9, Sankhu. Few studies integrate demographic, socioeconomic, and policy perspectives simultaneously at the local level. Additionally, there is limited recent research reflecting post-2015 changes in migration patterns due to infrastructure development and urban expansion. Finally, little attention has been given to local planning implications and migrant integration at the ward level, highlighting the need for this study to provide context-specific insights and support evidence-based planning.

2.5 Conceptual Framework

The conceptual framework for this study illustrates the relationship between push-pull factors, personal characteristics, migration decisions, and their socio-economic consequences (Figure 2.1).

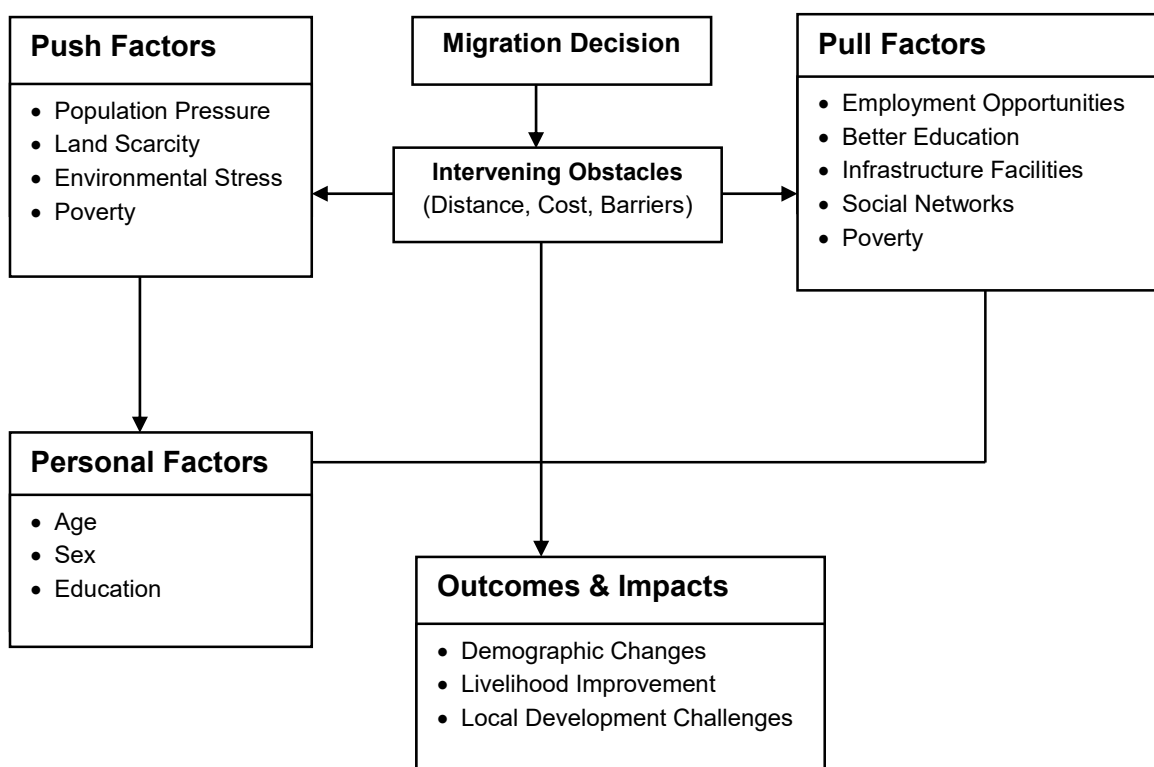


Figure 2.1 Conceptual Framework of Migration Study

- **Push factors:** Population pressure, land scarcity, environmental stress, poverty
- **Pull factors:** Employment opportunities, education, infrastructure, social networks
- **Personal factors:** Age, sex, education
- **Outcome/impact:** Demographic changes, livelihood improvement, local development challenges

The framework guides the research methodology, data collection, and analysis, ensuring that the study captures the causes, patterns, and consequences of migration in Ward 9, Sankhu.

Chapter-Three

Research methodology

3.1 Rationale of Selection of Study Area

The choice of Shankharapur Municipality Ward 9 (Sankhu) as the focal point for this research is based on the following strategic justifications:

Shankharapur is a rapidly developing municipality on the periphery of Kathmandu that is currently experiencing a continuous, daily influx of in-migrants. This constant population movement creates an immediate and high-priority need to investigate the resulting socio-economic and demographic consequences, whether positive or negative.

The selection of Ward 9 is highly practical for a Master's level study. With a total of 82 households, the ward provides a sample size that is manageable within the researcher's specific constraints of time, financial resources, and expert manpower, ensuring the study can be implemented with the required depth.

To ensure the study remains objective and free from researcher bias, the area was chosen through a random sampling method from the Kathmandu district level. Subsequently, a purposive sampling method will be applied to draw relevant data from the migrant population within those households.

Existing literature on migration in Nepal is largely dominated by macro-level or city-wide analyses. There is a significant lack of context-specific research that integrates demographic, socio-economic, and policy perspectives at a localized ward level, particularly in areas like Ward 9 that have seen shifts following the 2015 earthquake.

This specific ward serves as an ideal "laboratory" to identify localized dynamics that can help planners and development practitioners design targeted interventions. The findings will identify new perspectives to enhance public participation and accelerate sustainable urban development within the municipality.

3.2 Research Design

The main objective of this research is to explore the trend, causes and consequences of immigration of the study area. In order to carry out the research properly, both descriptive and exploratory research designs will be used. It will explore the causes concerned with immigration within the immigrants.

3.3 Nature and source of data

This study will base on both primary and secondary data. Primary data will be collected in the field with the help of different tools and techniques; interview and observation. On the other hand, the secondary data will be obtained from library, published and unpublished articles, documents, books and CBS records and the municipality record of the study area.

3.4 Population and Sampling

The Shankharapur Municipality ward 9 profile – 2082 BS shows that there is a total population of about 4345. Out of 9 wards, ward no.9 will be considered as study area. This ward welcomed 82 households with total count of 336 immigrants from year 2074 BS to 2082 BS. These households will be sampled for the study. Because of the time, resources, expert manpower and proper implication of the study, random sampling method will be used to sample these households. To draw the sample from whole population, purposive method will be used.

3.5 Method of Data Collection

In order to obtain necessary and reliable data for thus study the researcher will use the method such as observation, unstructured interview and some case study.

3.5.1 Observation

Observation method will use to collect the observable information such as social status. Community participation, role in community decision making, their relationship between the immigrants and residential. The immigration will be observed to find out the causes and consequences in the development sector of the study area

3.5.2 Interview

An unstructured interview will be taken so as to meet the purposes. The questionnaire will be divided into four sections. The first section deals with the purpose of getting information about demographic variables. The second section will deal with the main reason behind the immigration, while the third section will be the socio-economic variables. The last section includes the miscellaneous questionnaire about the causes and consequences of immigration within the study area.

3.6 Data Analysis and Presentation

Qualitative data will be presented on tabular form. Both qualitative and quantitative methods will be used to analyze the obtain information.

3.7 Ethical Consideration

1. Formal approval will obtain from ward office.
2. Verbal consent will obtain from each participant before data collection
3. Purpose of the study will be briefly informed to participants
4. Confidentiality will maintain throughout the study period

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